The Final Putts

72

BDT 2023 & 2024 · Featuring Gav, Langers, Rufus, Hulmey & Robbo

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

BDT 2024 in Turkey was a fiercely contested tour. On BDT 2022, the Bloodhounds had won back the Ryder Cup and then on BDT 2023 they had retained it after a 12-12 draw so they were looking to hold onto the cup for a third successive tour, whilst the Retrievers were equally keen to win it back!

The 18th at Gloria New Course was a tremendous finishing hole. A Par 5 with water all the way down the left meant that there were plenty of squeaky bums on the tee and no less than three matches had already been decided on the 18th with the water coming into play on a number of occasions!

When the final group reached the tee, the Retrievers needed one point from the two remaining matches which were Hulmey v Rufus and Langers v Gav. Rufus was 1UP on Hulmey but hit the drink three times (!) to lose the hole and secure just half a point. So, quite incredibly, after three rounds of golf and 1,187 holes between that year's 22 golfers, the destiny of the Ryder Cup all came down to the final match, between Langers and Gav.

To amplify the pressure on their shoulders, all the Dogs congregated by the 18th green to watch the denouement.



▶ **Watch:** The Final Putt of BDT 2024!

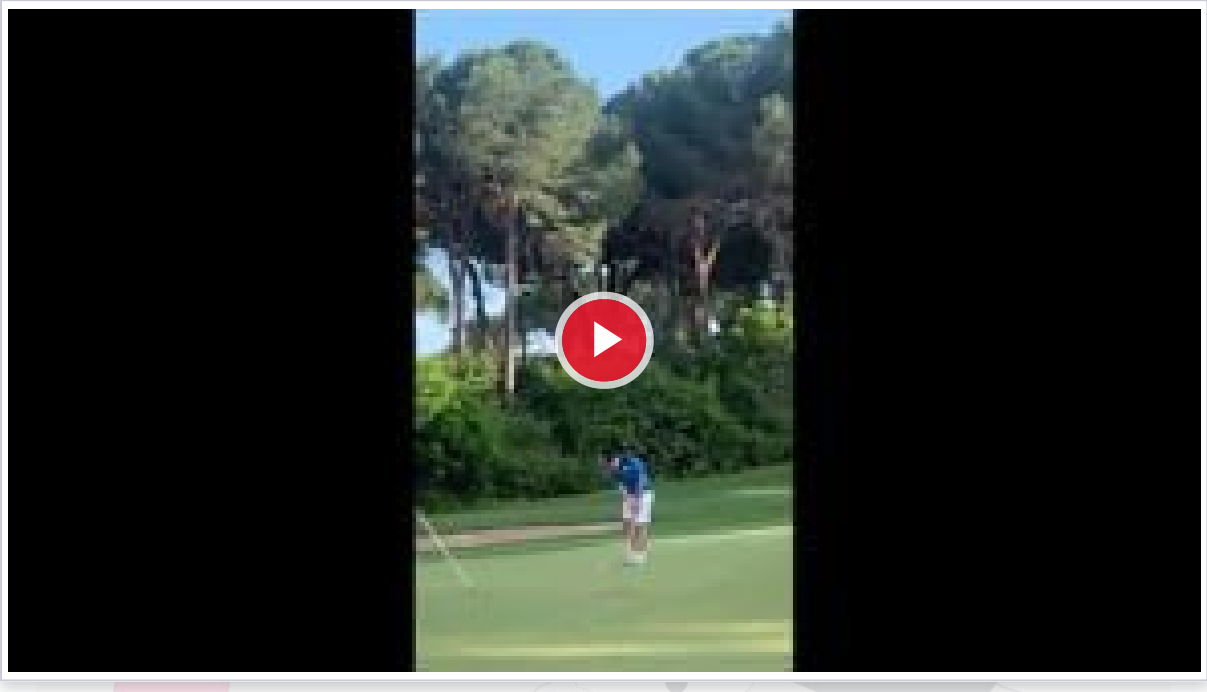
It was neck and neck as they approached the green, although Gav hit a chip around 25 feet past the hole, whereas Langers was a little closer. Gav rolled his putt down the slope but it went a good few feet past! Langers hit a great putt that almost dropped but ended at gimme length! So it all came down to Gav's final putt – talk about pressure!

Sadly for the Retrievers, but to the Bloodhounds' great joy, the putt just drifted right and the Bloodhounds "retained the retain"! The moment was captured on camera for posterity!

Equally incredibly, this was the second consecutive tour on which everything came down to the final putt. On BDT 2023, the final match was Langers vs Robbo, a titanic battle which also happened to be between two of the leading protagonists for the Green Jacket that year.

Being one down on 18, Robbo could not win the match and with the Retrievers needing a whole point to win back the Ryder Cup the most that could be achieved was a half point in order to ensure that the Bloodhounds only retained the trophy that they had won on BDT 2022, rather than winning it.

Again, the key moment was captured for posterity on camera…



▶ **Watch:** The Final Putt of BDT 2023!

The closest five finishes on BDT

#	TOUR	VENUE	SCORE (BH – RT)	RESULT
1=	BDT 2014	Marbella	10 – 10	Drawn – Retrievers retained the cup
1=	BDT 2023	Turkey	12 – 12	Drawn – Bloodhounds retained the cup
1=	BDT 2024	Turkey	11½ – 11½	Drawn – Bloodhounds retained the cup
4	BDT 2026	Scottsdale	11½ – 12½	Retrievers won by 1 point out of 24
5=	BDT 2006	Mallorca	7½ – 8½	Retrievers won by 1 point out of 16
5=	BDT 2010	Girona	8½ – 7½	Bloodhounds won by 1 point out of 16
5=	BDT 2017	Mallorca	7½ – 8½	Retrievers won by 1 point out of 16

From the Master Playbook. Three cups have been drawn; the next closest were won by a single point, so the 1-point wins are ranked by squad size.